## 6.6 STITCHING TOOLS

Stitching tools are the tools which enhance the sewing action by hand and machine. The common stitching tools are needle, thread, thimble, needle threader, bodkin and loop turner (Figure 6.5).

### Needle

Needles are thin, long metal stick like structures. It has a sharp edge on one end and hole called eye on the other end. The thread used for sewing is passed through the eye.

Needles used for hand sewing or embroidery is called hand needle. Needle which is used in the machine is called machine needle. Size and number of the needle should be based on the type of fabric.

There are different types of needles. Long needles are used for darning. Ordinary needle are used for stitching normal stitches and for tacking. Embroidery needle has a long and oval hole. The points may be sharp or blunt depending upon the stitch. The needles should be stored carefully in a rust proof paper to prevent from rust.

### Thread

Thread used for sewing is long smooth yarn wound on spool or reel. The selection of threads varies based upon the colour, thickness and type of fabric. The sewing threads are usually made of cotton or nylon. Silk threads are also available.

**DO YOU KNOW?**

**How was early sewing thread made?**

Early sewing thread consisted of thin strips of animal hide that were used to stitch together larger pieces of hide and fur.




### Thimble

Thimble is a small tumbler shaped tool. It is made up of plastic or metal. It is used to protect the finger from being pricked by the needle when sewing. It is used in the middle finger.


Needle


Thread


Thimble

Figure 6.5 Stitching Tools



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